

GazeAIDE

JetBrains IDE Plugin — Setup Instructions

What is GazeAIDE?

GazeAIDE simulates eye-tracking gaze using your mouse cursor, inspired by the CodeGRITS research toolkit. It runs in two modes as you work in the editor:

Reading mode — while your mouse is moving, a circle appears in the gutter marking the current line.

Explaining mode — when your mouse rests on a line for 3 seconds, the line is highlighted and GPT-4o-mini generates an inline explanation using the surrounding function as context.

Installing the Plugin

You will receive a file named **gaze-highlighter-0.1.0.zip**. Do not unzip it.

1. Open your JetBrains IDE (IntelliJ IDEA, PyCharm, etc.).
2. Open **Settings** — press **Cmd + ,** on Mac or **Ctrl + Alt + S** on Windows/Linux.
3. Navigate to **Plugins** in the left sidebar.
4. Click the **gear icon** at the top of the Plugins panel.
5. Select **Install Plugin from Disk...**
6. Browse to and select the **.zip** file.
7. Click **OK**, then restart the IDE when prompted.

*After restarting, you will see a **GazeAIDE: Reading** indicator in the status bar at the bottom of the IDE.*

Setting Up Your OpenAI API Key

The Explaining mode requires an OpenAI API key. You need to provide your own key. Set it using one of the two methods below:

Option A — Via the IDE (recommended)

1. Go to **Help** → **Edit VM Options**.
2. Add the following line:

```
-DOPENAI_API_KEY=your-key-here
```

3. Save the file and **restart the IDE**.

Option B — Via environment variable

Add the following to your shell profile (**~/.zshrc** or **~/.bashrc**):

```
export OPENAI_API_KEY=your-key-here
```

On Mac, launch the IDE from the terminal for it to inherit the environment variable.

If the key is not set, the plugin will show the message: "Set OPENAI_API_KEY in Help → Edit VM Options" instead of an explanation.

For questions, contact the plugin author.